centre for pediatric emergencies and specialized care

Wrist Guard Care

You have a wrist guard (i.e. a splint) to protect your broken bone from moving, to help healing, and/or to minimize pain

- This splint serves the same purpose as a cast, with the advantage of it being removable briefly for bathing or scratching
- Unless otherwise instructed by your doctor, it should be kept on 24 hours a day

What should you expect in the first few weeks?

You may have **PAIN** for the first week. To control your pain:

- Use Ibuprofen or Acetaminophen (unless allergic). Follow the instructions on the bottle
- Keep the broken bone raised, using a sling/pillow, to lower the swelling

Do we need a follow-up appointment?

DEPENDS. Most BUCKLE fractures of the radius require no follow-up given how well they heal. However, wrist guards are used for a variety of other fracture types as well so YOUR doctor will inform you of next steps prior to leaving UP

- **If YES,** our team will book an appointment for you for a re-assessment. If a referral to an orthopedic surgeon was needed, our team will ensure to transmit the referral electronically and inform you of next steps

- **IF NO**, you may remove and stop using the wrist guard after 2 weeks once pain is resolved
  - If you still have pain longer than 6 weeks, return to Centre UP at the site closest to your home between 8am-8pm (ideally earlier in day is better); no appointment needed

What do I do if have concerns or pain getting worse?

- Return to UP between 8am-8pm (earlier in day is better); no appointment needed
- If notice something at night, unless severe pain or major concern, can come first thing in the AM